

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Tote Bag Pattern for Beginners

A sturdy market-style tote built from single crochet, with two simple chain-and-strap handles.

Updated 2026 · US terms · About 13in / 33cm wide, 14in / 36cm tall



This tote is built the same way as our [beanie pattern](#) crown — a flat circle base, then straight rounds — just scaled up and left open at the top instead of closed. Sturdy cotton yarn and a firm stitch make it hold its shape under real grocery weight.

MATERIALS

- 3–4 skeins worsted-weight cotton yarn (about 400–500 yards total)
- 5.0mm (US size H) crochet hook
- Stitch marker, to track the start of each round
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in same stitch (increase)
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

 Cotton yarn skeins for a sturdy crochet bag

GAUGE

14 sc and 16 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.0mm hook and worsted cotton. Firmer tension than usual is fine here and actually helps the bag hold weight without stretching.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, worked in a continuous spiral for the base and body — same technique as our [beanie pattern](#). Use a stitch marker to track round

starts.

- Cotton yarn is strongly recommended over acrylic; acrylic stretches under weight and won't hold a bag shape well.
- For a heavier-duty bag, hold two strands of yarn together throughout for extra strength.

Pattern

BASE, ROUND 1

Make a magic ring, 6 sc into ring, place marker. (6 sts)

BASE, ROUND 2

Inc in every st around. (12 sts)

BASE, ROUNDS 3–9

Continue increasing by 6 sts each round, following the pattern [sc n, inc] where n increases by 1 each round (round 3: [sc 1, inc], round 4: [sc 2, inc], and so on) until round 9. (72 sts by round 9)

BODY, ROUNDS 10–24

Sc in every st around, no increases, for 15 rounds. (72 sts each round)

HANDLES, ROUND 25

Sc 15, ch 20 (skip next 6 sts, leaving a gap for the first handle), sc 21, ch 20 (skip next 6 sts for the second handle), sc in remaining sts to end of round. (72 sts total, including the two 20-chain gaps)

ROUND 26

Sc in every st around, working sc into each chain from both handle gaps as if they were regular stitches. (72 sts)

ROUNDS 27–28

Sc in every st around for 2 more rounds to reinforce the handle openings.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

What yarn is best for a crochet tote bag?

Cotton yarn is the standard choice for bags, since it's sturdier and holds shape better under weight than acrylic, which can stretch and sag once loaded with items.

How much yarn do I need for a crochet tote bag?

A medium tote bag uses roughly 400 to 500 yards of worsted-weight cotton yarn, typically 3 to 4 standard skeins depending on the brand.

How do I make the straps on a crochet tote bag stronger?

Working the straps in single crochet rather than a looser stitch, and doubling the strand of yarn if the bag will carry heavy items, both add strength and reduce stretching over time.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.